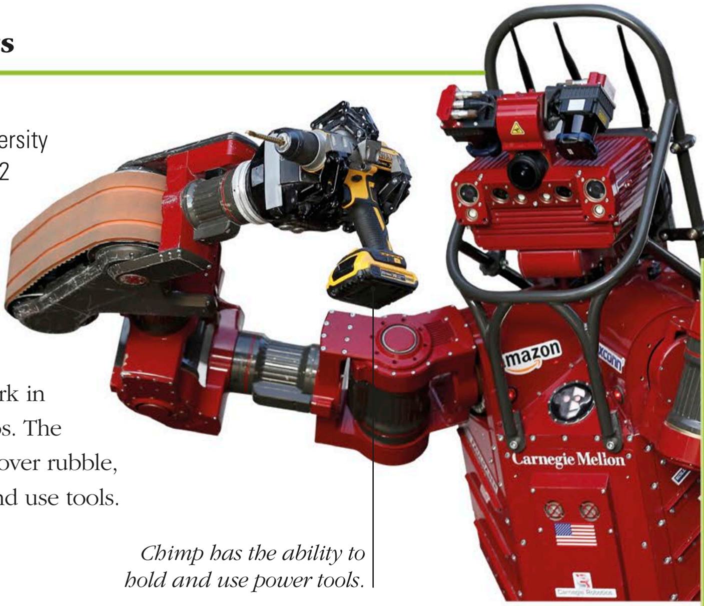
FAST FACTS

- In 2016, a NAO robot nicknamed "Connie" became a hotel Hilton concierge in Virginia. It answered peoples' questions about the hotel and offered recommendations for restaurants and points of interest.
- AIBO collects data as it interacts with users, processing and recording everything it experiences.

Disaster-relief robots

- **What?** Chimp
- **Who?** Carnegie Mellon University
- **Where and when?** US, 2012

Chimp was one of many robots designed to compete in a US Defense Agency challenge in 2015. The competition promoted the development of robots to work in emergency-response scenarios. The robots had to drive, clamber over rubble, open doors, climb ladders, and use tools.



Chimp has the ability to hold and use power tools.

Educational robots

- **What?** NAO
- **Who?** SoftBank Group
- **Where and when?** France, 2004

NAO (pronounced "now") began life as the robot used in the RoboCup—an annual international robot soccer competition. It still plays in this competition, but increasingly this little robot is used for research and educational purposes in numerous academic institutions worldwide. Today, more than 10,000 NAO robots are in use in more than 50 countries. In a UK school, this robot was used to teach autistic children, as they can be a calming, positive influence on those with special educational needs.

The six-wheeled delivery bot can travel up to 4 mph (6.5 km/h).

Self-driving delivery bots

- **What?** Self-driving delivery robot
- **Who?** Starship Technologies
- **Where and when?** US, 2015

In some cities, pedestrians are getting used to sharing pavement space with small robot vehicles taking fast food orders to customers. On arrival, the person receiving the delivery keys a code into their smartphone to access their food. San Francisco and Washington, D.C., as well as Tallinn in Estonia, are already using this technology, and many more countries are now testing it.

Warrior robots

- **What?** Spot
- **Who?** Boston Dynamics
- **Where and when?** US, 2015

Boston Dynamics developed the first robots to run and maneuver like dogs. One of them, BigDog, was designed as a robotic packhorse to carry equipment over rough terrain into battle for the US Army. However, it proved to be too noisy and so the company developed smaller, quieter versions called Spot (right), then SpotMini.